

Rental 360

First-time experiences,
made clearer.

Your Singapore rental journey, from viewing
to handing back the keys.



For your first place, your first home together,
or your first home in Singapore.

Your journey, at a glance

FROM FIRST VIEWING TO FINAL SETTLEMENT



Tap the timeline or a content entry to jump to that page.

BEFORE YOU COMMIT

- 03** Viewing the home
- 04** Getting the LOI right
- 05** Deposits, payments and fees
- 06** Reading the TA

MOVING IN

- 07** Utilities and moving arrangements
- 08** Recording the condition
- 09** Your first 30 days

LIVING THERE

- 10** Who pays for repairs?
- 11** When something breaks
- 12** Looking after the home

MOVING OUT

- 13** Preparing for handback
- 14** The final inspection
- 15** Deposit return and disagreements

KEEP IT SIMPLE

- 16** Your rental system
- 17** How Estate Basics supports you

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This guide provides general educational information about renting private residential homes in Singapore. It does not constitute legal, financial, technical or other professional advice, and should not be relied on as a substitute for advice tailored to your circumstances.

Rental arrangements differ. References to deposits, repair contributions, defect-reporting periods, servicing, cleaning and refund deadlines are examples or general guidance, not terms that automatically apply to every tenancy. Read your signed Letter of Intent and Tenancy Agreement together with any agreed amendments and applicable law. This guide does not amend those documents or determine either party's rights or obligations.

Although reasonable care has been taken in preparing this guide, information, regulations, bank procedures, service requirements and costs may change. Readers should verify relevant details with the appropriate authority, service provider or qualified adviser before signing, paying, arranging work or making a claim.

Estate Basics, Amethyst and Angie do not guarantee the condition or suitability of a property, the performance of third parties, the absence of disputes or the return of any particular deposit amount. To the extent permitted by applicable law, they disclaim liability for losses arising from reliance on this guide, including errors, omissions or outdated information. Nothing in this disclaimer excludes or limits liability that cannot lawfully be excluded or limited, or overrides obligations expressly agreed under a separate service agreement.

01 / VIEWING

Look beyond the room you already love

YOU SAY

The living room feels right.

WE SAY

Now check the things that could become a problem later.

Open it.

With permission, check cupboards, drawers and beneath the sink. Look for swelling, stains, dampness and unusual smells.

Try it.

Check taps, toilet flushing, doors and windows. Ask about appliances and aircon that cannot be tested at the viewing.

Listen.

Pause the conversation. Notice traffic, construction, neighbouring activity and corridor noise.

Picture an ordinary weekday.

Where will you work, dry clothes and charge devices? Will your furniture fit comfortably?

Confirm what stays.

Furniture and appliances on display may belong to the current tenant.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Sort your notes into **must fix**, **must provide** and **happy to accept**.
Turn the first two into requests before committing.

For example: an old stain is worth asking about. If it was repaired, ask what caused it, what was done and whether it is still happening.

02 / LETTER OF INTENT

Put the promise on paper

LANDLORD / LANDLORD'S REP SAYS

We can probably provide a sofa.

WE SAY

Turn that conversation into a clear written request.

Your **Letter of Intent (LOI)** should identify the proposed rent, lease period, commencement and handover dates, occupants, deposit arrangements and agreed requests.

Be specific about the requests.

List repairs, furniture to provide or remove, cleaning, initial aircon servicing, pet permission and completion dates.

Understand the good faith deposit.

Check the offer expiry and **Tenancy Agreement (TA)** signing deadline, when the money is refundable or may be forfeited, and how it counts towards later payments. Do not assume a change of mind means an automatic refund.

MAKE SURE YOUR MONEY CAN MOVE

Check your balance and daily transfer limit; increase it in advance if needed. Verify the recipient, add the payee early where required and make sure your banking app and token are ready.

Banks may impose cooling periods for limit increases, new payees or token activation. Allow **12-24 hours or longer**, depending on the bank and action. Check before signing the LOI.

03 / DEPOSITS AND PAYMENTS

Know what you pay, and when

Security deposit (SD): market practice is often one month's rent for a one-year lease and two months for a two-year lease. Some landlords ask for two months even for one year. **Ask and negotiate before signing.**

The SD is usually not available to pay your final month's rent. The landlord holds it to secure your obligations, checks the home at the end and may make deductions allowed by the TA, returning the balance.

EXAMPLE / 2-YEAR LEASE · \$4,000 MONTHLY RENT**AT THE LOI**

\$4,000

1 month good faith deposit
Later credited towards the SD

**AT TA SIGNING**

\$8,000

1 more month SD: \$4,000
+ 1 month advance rent: \$4,000

Total by TA signing: \$12,000 = \$8,000 security deposit + \$4,000 first month's rent. This assumes the agreed payment schedule above; other fees are separate.

STAMP DUTY / A QUICK CALCULATION

Monthly rental × total lease months × 0.4%

Example: $\$4,000 \times 24 \times 0.4\% = \384

Pay \$384

Round down to the whole dollar. Formula shown for flat rent and leases of up to four years, where average annual rent exceeds \$1,000. IRAS uses the higher of contractual or market rent, including applicable charges; minimum duty is \$1.

Agency fee

A common fee arrangement is **one month's rent for two years** or **half a month for one year**, plus GST where applicable. Agree whether a tenant-paid fee applies and record it before engaging your representative.

04 / TENANCY AGREEMENT

Know what you're agreeing to

YOU SAY

The TA looks fine. I assume it is a standard agreement and reflects what we agreed in the LOI.

WE SAY

Let's check what else you're agreeing to.

Make sure your LOI requests are included or clearly incorporated into the TA.

Repair costs

Check your contribution, the exceptions and when approval is required.

Aircon obligations

Check servicing frequency, contractor requirements, chemical washing, gas top-ups and missing-record charges.

Leaving early

Check qualifying conditions, notice, evidence and commission reimbursement. A diplomatic clause is not a general cancellation option for every renter.

Living together

Confirm who is a tenant and who is an authorised occupier. Understand what happens if one person wants to leave.

Handback and deposit return

Check cleaning, curtains, repainting, receipts, service charges, permitted deductions and the refund deadline.

A CLAUSE WORTH SPOTTING

A fixed charge if handback work or receipts are incomplete. Ask what triggers it and negotiate unclear or onerous terms before signing.

05 / BEFORE MOVE-IN

Get your move-in essentials ready

Utilities

Open your SP account and coordinate the start date. Ask the landlord / landlord's rep about taking over the supply before anyone arranges disconnection.

Internet

Book internet installation early and check the available connection.

Moving

Arrange resident registration, moving slots, lift protection and any condominium moving deposit.

The home itself

Confirm when outstanding repairs and cleaning will be completed.

Stamping

Arrange stamping and keep the Stamp Certificate. Documents signed in Singapore generally need stamping within 14 days after signing.

SP SUPPLY / TWO POSSIBLE ROUTES



SUPPLY STAYS ON

Ask about a coordinated takeover. Once confirmed by SP, your account starts on the agreed date and may avoid a turn-on visit.



SUPPLY IS CUT OFF

Reactivation may require a turn-on appointment, with you or an authorised person present for access and checks.

USEFUL LINKS

[SP Group: residential utilities guide](#)

[IRAS Stamping guide](#)

06 / HANDOVER

Record it now. Avoid regrets later.

"It was already there." A clear photo gives you something to show.

Without evidence of the original condition, it can be harder to challenge a deduction later. Take responsibility for your own record, even when the landlord / landlord's rep also takes photos.

Check the inventory and condition together before signing. Record existing damage, missing items and agreed follow-up work.

THE THREE-PHOTO METHOD

01



THE ROOM

Show where it sits.



02



THE ITEM

Show the whole item.



03



THE DETAIL

Make the defect clear.

Capture cupboard interiors, sink cabinets, flooring edges, shower screens, appliance interiors, remotes, keys and access cards. Use short videos for intermittent faults, noises or leaks.

A WIDE SHOT IS ONLY THE START

A photo of a clean kitchen may not show a cracked fridge shelf. Add the close-up, keep the original files and make sure you can access the complete condition record.

An organised record gives you a stronger basis to discuss your security deposit.



USE OUR HANDOVERX CONDITION REPORT

Document the condition from your phone. Mobile-friendly.

handoverx.estatebasics.sg

07 / FIRST 30 DAYS

Try everything. Keep one clear defect list.

Check your TA for when the **30-day defect period starts and ends**. Begin checking the home as soon as you get access, and send your report before the stated deadline.

TEST ACCORDING TO THE APPLIANCE INSTRUCTIONS

- Every aircon unit and remote.
- Washer cycles, drainage and any dryer.
- Oven, hob, hood and refrigerator.
- Taps, flushing, hot water and drainage.
- Lights, accessible sockets, locks, keys and access cards.

Photograph cosmetic defects too, even where the repair period only covers functional or safety issues. Good records support your position if a disagreement arises.

CONSOLIDATE THE ROUTINE ISSUES

Keep one numbered list of non-urgent issues with the **location, symptoms and supporting images**. Send a consolidated report towards the end of the checking period, with time to spare **before the TA deadline**. A single organised report is easier to track than scattered messages.

Do not wait for urgent faults: report leaks, a water heater or stove that does not work, and anything needing a quick fix promptly.



USE OUR HANDOVERX CONDITION REPORT

Document the condition from your phone. Mobile-friendly.

handoverx.estatebasics.sg

08 / REPAIR RESPONSIBILITIES

Who pays for repairs?

Usually the tenant: utilities, housekeeping, agreed servicing, the minor-repair contribution and tenant-caused damage due to misuse or negligence.

Usually the landlord: property tax, structural and concealed-system repairs allocated to the landlord, and costs above the minor-repair contribution for qualifying repairs. Separate clauses and exceptions still apply.

How a \$250 minor-repair contribution works

The amount is negotiated, often in the **\$200-\$400 range**, but may differ. The example below uses **\$250 per item per repair**, after any initial repair period and with required approval.

Eligible repair	Tenant pays	Landlord pays
\$120	\$120	\$0
\$350	\$250	\$100
\$600	\$250	\$350

THREE DOOR KNOBS / ONE INVOICE

\$100

\$100

\$100

Tenant pays \$300

Landlord pays \$0

Each knob costs \$100 to repair, so each falls below \$250. The tenant pays all three. **It is per item, not per invoice:** combining them into a \$300 invoice does not make the landlord pay \$50.

MISUSE, NEGLIGENCE AND DELAYED REPORTING

The \$250 contribution does not cap liability for tenant misuse or negligence. The **full repair or replacement cost** attributable to it may be payable.

For example: failing to report a ceiling leak can amount to negligence. If the ceiling deteriorates as a result, the landlord may claim the **full cost of the resulting repairs**, subject to the TA and evidence of causation.

If the landlord alleges negligence, request the contractor's findings. A breakdown alone does not prove it.

09 / DURING THE TENANCY

Something broke. Here's the next move.

01 LIMIT DAMAGE

Stop using the affected item where appropriate and limit further damage safely.

02 RECORD IT

Take photos or video. Note the location, symptoms and when the problem started.

03 CONTACT THE LANDLORD / LANDLORD'S REP

Ask whether there is a preferred contractor and who should arrange the visit.

04 AGREE THE WORK

Confirm the quotation, approval and who pays the call-out and repair costs. Keep the diagnosis and receipt.

A MESSAGE YOU CAN USE

Hi, the washing machine is leaking during the drain cycle. I noticed it today and have stopped using it. Photos and a video are attached. Is there a preferred contractor? Please confirm the next steps and cost arrangement before I book.

For emergencies, use the agreed emergency process and seek urgent help where necessary. Keep a record of attempts to contact the landlord / landlord's rep.

10 / HOME CARE

A little care, all year round

Keep moisture under control.

Singapore is humid. Ventilate appropriately, dry wet surfaces and watch for water around sinks or on timber flooring. Report leaks early.

Hang it with care.

Get permission before drilling. Suitable removable hooks or adhesives, such as 3M products, may minimise damage; follow the instructions and your TA. If the wall is damaged, making good and repainting may be your responsibility.

Treat surfaces and appliances gently.

Use suitable cleaners, furniture pads and protective mats. Wipe spills promptly, follow appliance instructions and clean dryer lint filters.

Keep bathrooms and kitchens clean.

Clean grease, soap residue and drains regularly to avoid months of build-up.

Give the oven some regular use.

In humid conditions, long periods of non-use can contribute to moisture-related tripping. Ask the manufacturer whether a **monthly run at 200°C for over 20 minutes** is suitable for your model; follow its instructions. Use conventional oven mode, never microwave mode. If it trips, stop and report it.

Use the right washer detergent.

Front-load washers need suitable **low-suds / HE detergent**, liquid or powder, in the recommended amount. The wrong detergent or too much can cause excess foam, faults and potential damage. A technician can assess the cause.

Service the aircon quarterly.

Arrange servicing every three months. Take up a maintenance contract with a qualified aircon company with appropriately certified technicians, and ask for appointment reminders so you do not miss a service. Check your TA for any landlord-appointed company you must use. Keep all servicing receipts.

11 / BEFORE HANDBACK

Small fixes now. Fewer surprises later.

About four weeks before moving out, walk through the home with your inventory and move-in photos. Check appliances, lights, remotes, keys, hinges, drainage and items you rarely use.

Arrange work early so everything is in good order for handback. Confirm responsibility and obtain approval where the TA requires it.

**\$10****The replacement bulb**

Resolve it before handback.

**\$50+****Bulb + visit + labour**

A contractor visit can add up.

Illustrative costs only; actual prices vary. Use qualified help where needed and obtain approval for work that requires it.

**BOOK CLEANING 2-3 WEEKS AHEAD**

We advise booking professional cleaning and curtain cleaning two to three weeks in advance to secure a slot. Schedule the work to meet your TA requirements and allow time to rehang curtains and inspect the clean.

Check cabinet interiors, wardrobes, appliances and areas behind furniture. Keep the cleaning and curtain receipts ready for handback.

A GOOD HANDBACK HELPS BOTH SIDES

Presenting the home well makes its condition easier to assess. It does not require you to accept responsibility for every sign of age.

12 / HANDBACK DAY

Leave the home. Keep a clear record.

Keep utilities available for the final checks and coordinate closure dates.

Walk through the property together and compare its condition with your move-in records.

YOUR HANDBACK PACK

- Inventory and original condition photos.
- Aircon servicing records.
- Professional cleaning and curtain receipts.
- Repair invoices and approvals.
- All keys, access cards and remotes.

**COMPARE**

Move-in vs handback

**RECORD**

Agree outstanding items

**RETURN**

Keys, cards and remotes

If something remains outstanding

Write down the item, proposed remedy, who will arrange it and the timing. Record disagreements rather than signing an inaccurate acknowledgement.

Before you leave

Confirm the key-return record, deposit refund details and contractual deadline. Avoid leaving with only "we will work it out later".

FAIR WEAR AND TEAR NEEDS A PROPER COMPARISON

Consider the starting condition, age, normal use and cause of the issue. Compare the evidence from both ends of the tenancy.

13 / DEPOSIT RETURN

Know when your refund clock starts

A **14-day refund period** is common in rental agreements, but the starting point varies. Some TAs count from the end of the tenancy or handback; others count from completion of agreed rectification work. **Check your exact clause.**

HANDBACK / LEASE END

14 days from the event stated in your TA

RECTIFICATION COMPLETE

14 days after the agreed work is finished

These are alternative clause examples, not two automatic deadlines. Record the applicable date and any agreed outstanding work in writing.

IF DEDUCTIONS ARE PROPOSED, ASK FOR

The item · The reason · The relevant clause
Supporting evidence · The amount

Compare the claim with your move-in and handback records. Ask how the item's existing condition and age have been considered.

If you disagree

Set out your position calmly in writing and seek an itemised resolution. Keep agreements and payment records. Ask for payment of any agreed balance.

If direct resolution fails

Consider mediation or the **Small Claims Tribunals** if the dispute qualifies. Eligibility includes restrictions on the type and value of claim; the residential lease must not exceed two years.

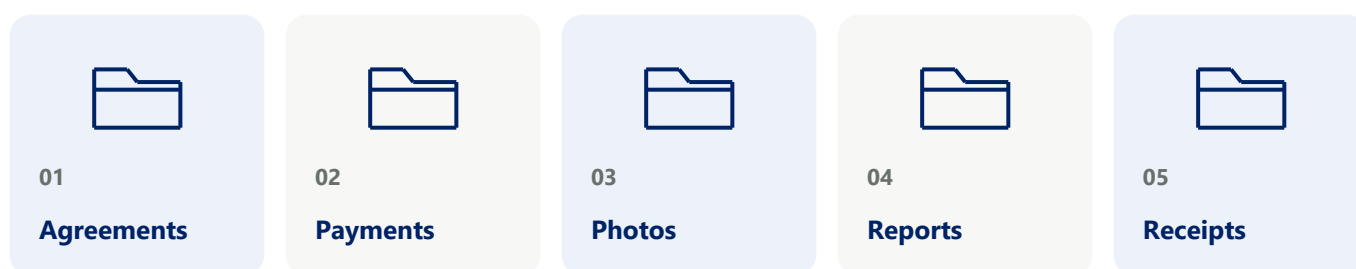
[Singapore Courts: cases eligible for a small claim](#)

14 / RENTAL TIPS

One rental. One simple system.

A little organisation now saves a lot of searching later.

ONE RENTAL FOLDER



Your evidence folder should grow with your tenancy: servicing records, repair approvals, receipts and reported defects. Do not wait until handback to reconstruct two years of maintenance.

Name files so you can find them.

Use a date, room and item: **2026-09-17_Kitchen_FridgeShelf**. Keep the original photo or video and link it to the relevant issue.

Keep one issue tracker.

Give each issue a number. Record the location, reported date, agreed action, person arranging it, cost approval and status: **open / booked / resolved**.

Put the dates in your calendar.

Add rent payments, your defect-reporting deadline, quarterly aircon servicing, renewal or notice dates, and cleaning bookings.

Back it up.

Keep a secure copy outside your phone. Make sure everyone named on the tenancy knows where the records are; avoid public sharing links.

Finish the paper trail.

After a call, send a short written recap of the agreed action and cost. Save approvals with the quotation, invoice and completion photo.

Your own representation, from viewing to handback.

Your first rental comes with plenty of questions. Have someone you can turn to throughout the journey.

AT THE VIEWING



You are imagining life in the space. We also check its condition, practical suitability and issues worth raising before you commit.

BEFORE YOU SIGN



We turn observations into clear LOI requests, review the TA with you, flag unclear or onerous terms and help negotiate reasonable arrangements.

AT HANDOVER



We use our HandoverX Condition Report System to document the home. We typically take 200-300 photos or more, saved in a separate Google Drive folder, to capture details of the existing condition.

THROUGH TO HANDBACK



We remain available to help you navigate maintenance issues, prepare for the final inspection and work through deposit questions.

HAVE SOMEONE ON YOUR SIDE

The landlord's rep represents the landlord.

Your own representative focuses on **YOU** and protects your interests.

Speak to us before your next viewing.

WhatsApp Amethyst

+65 8201 9831

CEA Reg. No. R052728B

WhatsApp Angie

+65 8396 3088

CEA Reg. No. R067805D